

SNEHAVARNGAL: A CELEBRATION OF TOGETHERNESS



Onam is more than a festival—it is a reminder of belonging, joy, and the strength of community. This year, on August 28, Palliative Care patients, their families, and community volunteers stepped out from their homes to celebrate Snehavarngal at Rajagiri Centre for Business Studies, Kakkanad. For many, it was the first time in months they were able to join such a gathering, and the excitement of being part of the festival was visible on their faces. The day began with a colourful pookkalam, made together by students, Arike staff, and volunteers. After a short and informal welcome, the celebration moved straight into games, where patients, children, and families joined in with laughter and cheer.



The moment found its true highlight in the Onam sadya, where patients, families, students, and volunteers sat together at one table. Sadya was served with love by the students of Rajagiri College, along with other members of Students' Initiative in Palliative Care (SIP). More than just a feast, it became a symbol of equality and companionship—everyone eating the same food, side by side, as one extended family. Alongside the meal, Arike distributed Onam food kits and the traditional 'Ona Kodi' to patients and their families, thanks to the support of micro-donations from our community.

The celebration was further enriched by cultural programmes, featuring heartfelt performances by the differently abled children of BUDS School. Their songs and dances drew warm applause and left behind smiles that carried the spirit of Onam home with everyone who attended.

Snehavarngal at Rajagiri was more than a festival gathering. It was a day that reminded patients and families that joy and dignity are still theirs, and that when the community comes together, festivals become truly complete.

We warmly invite you to be part of our future events—through your presence, time, contributions in cash or kind, or simply by sharing a moment with those in need. Every gesture of care adds meaning, and together we can keep creating days like this.



MOU SIGNING



Arike Palliative Home Care has signed an MoU with De Paul Institute of Science & Technology (DiST), Angamaly, to set up a palliative care unit on the campus. The initiative aims to inspire students to engage in compassionate service by raising awareness, providing training, and encouraging volunteer participation. This collaboration seeks to build a culture of empathy and create a sustainable model of community-centered care in the Angamaly region.

ARIKE ANNIVERSARY

Arike celebrated its 6th anniversary on 7th August 2025, marking six years of compassionate service in the field of palliative care. The occasion highlighted the growing importance of home-based care and the vital role of community awareness in making support accessible and effective. It also emphasized the need for sustainable residential units to provide continuous psychosocial support for patients and families. The anniversary served as both a moment of gratitude for the journey so far and a reaffirmation of Arike's mission to build compassionate, community-centered networks of care. Looking ahead, Arike remains committed to expanding its reach and deepening its impact in the years to come.



SENSITIZATION AT ALUVA

On 11th August 2025, the Networking Team organized an awareness session at District Hospital, Aluva, on the importance of spirituality and bereavement in palliative care. The session was attended by 10 BCCPN students and focused on enhancing their understanding of how spiritual support and effective bereavement care can improve the quality of life for patients and families.



SENSITIZATION AT DIVISION 71

On 12th August 2025, the team conducted a sensitization program at Division 71 of the Cochin Corporation. The session aimed to create awareness about the importance of community involvement in palliative care and to encourage local residents and leaders to play an active role in supporting patients and families. Discussions highlighted how compassionate neighborhoods can provide emotional, social, and practical support, thereby strengthening the overall care network. The program also encouraged participants to volunteer and engage in future initiatives, fostering a stronger sense of collective responsibility within the community.

UNARV AT ST. XAVIER'S WOMEN'S COLLEGE

On 12th August 2025, the team successfully conducted a one-day training session on palliative care at St. Xavier's Women's College, Aluva, as part of the comprehensive three-day training program "UNARV." The session aimed to provide students with a deeper understanding of the principles of palliative care, emphasizing holistic approaches that address physical, emotional, and psychosocial needs. Interactive discussions and practical insights helped participants connect classroom learning with real-life scenarios, fostering greater sensitivity and preparedness to support patients and families.



UNARV AT SH COLLEGE, THEVARA

As part of the three-day training program "UNARV," the team conducted a one-day session on palliative care at Sacred Heart College, Thevara, on 14th August 2025. The session aimed to raise awareness among students about the principles of palliative care, emphasizing empathy, compassionate support for patients and families, and inspiring them to become future advocates of caring communities. Through interactive discussions and real-life examples, students were encouraged to reflect on how they can make a positive impact in the lives of those in need. The program also highlighted the importance of community involvement and the role each individual can play in promoting dignity and comfort for patients.

“CHIRAKUKAL” – PATIENT GET-TOGETHER



On 16th August, the Department of Social Work, along with the Palliative Care Club and NSS unit of Rajagiri College of Social Sciences, Kalamassery, in collaboration with Arike Palliative Care, hosted a special patient get-together at the college. The event brought together patients, students, and volunteers for a day of interaction, sharing, and meaningful connection. Through engaging activities, conversations, and collaborative sessions, participants experienced a sense of community and mutual support. The gathering highlighted the importance of empathy, compassion, and care, inspiring students and volunteers to continue their efforts in supporting patients and their families. It was a heartwarming day that strengthened bonds and celebrated the spirit of human connection.

UNARV – AT RAJAGIRI VISWAJYOTHI COLLEGE OF ARTS & APPLIED SCIENCES



On 19th August 2025, as part of the three-day “UNARV” program, the team organized a special one-day session on palliative care at Rajagiri Viswajyothi College of Arts & Applied Sciences, Perumbavoor. The session aimed to sensitize students to the principles of palliative care, emphasizing the importance of empathy, compassion, and holistic support for patients facing serious illnesses. Through interactive discussions, case studies, and real-life examples, students were encouraged to reflect on their role in promoting dignified care and supporting families in need. The program also highlighted how small acts of kindness and understanding can make a significant difference in the lives of patients and foster a culture of compassionate care within the community.

UNARV – DAY 3 AT DIST, ANGAMALY



On 22nd August 2025, the team successfully conducted the third and final day of the palliative care awareness workshop at De Paul, Angamaly, as part of the comprehensive three-day “UNARV” training program. The session aimed to strengthen students’ understanding of palliative care, focusing on empathy, compassionate support, and holistic care for patients and their families. Through interactive discussions, real-life case studies, and engaging activities, participants explored practical ways to address the physical, emotional, and social needs of patients. The program also emphasized the importance of community involvement and inspired students to become proactive advocates of compassionate care within their own communities. The day concluded on a reflective note, encouraging students to carry forward the principles of dignity, respect, and empathy in all their future endeavors.

UNARV AT ST. PAUL’S COLLEGE, KALAMASSERY



On 30th August 2025, the team successfully conducted a one-day training session on palliative care at St. Paul’s College, Kalamassery, as part of the comprehensive three-day “UNARV” training program. The session focused on building students’ awareness of palliative care principles, highlighting the importance of empathy, compassion, and holistic support for patients and their families. Through interactive discussions and real-life examples, students were encouraged to reflect on their role in promoting compassionate care within their communities.

LET’S TALK MEETINGS

In the past month, the team successfully conducted 16 sessions of “Let’s Talk”, bringing together all staff members of Arike and dedicated volunteers. These sessions provided a platform to openly discuss the challenges and sufferings faced by patients, share insights, and collaboratively explore ways to alleviate their difficulties. Through these discussions, the team reinforced their commitment to improving patient care and fostering a compassionate, supportive environment for those in need.



OBSERVATION VISITS



During the past month, the team facilitated two observation visits, offering students a valuable opportunity to gain practical insight into palliative care. The first visit was organized for sociology students from St. Teresa's College, Ernakulam, and the second for social work students from Don Bosco College, Sulthan Bathery. During these visits, students observed the day-to-day activities of the palliative care team, interacted with patients, and learned about the challenges and rewards of providing compassionate care. The sessions also included discussions with staff and volunteers, allowing students to understand the holistic approach required to support patients physically, emotionally, and socially. These observation visits not only enriched the students' academic learning but also inspired them to carry forward the values of empathy, kindness, and patient-centered care in their future professional and personal endeavors.

SUPPORT OUR MISSION

We warmly encourage you to contribute to Arike, enabling us to make a meaningful and lasting difference in the lives of individuals requiring palliative care.

Payments can be transferred to our account.

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